

Engagement Survey Action Plan (9/6/23)

Areas of Focus	Action Items
Why & How This focuses on clarifying the purpose and goals of Asbury Seminary, engaging the entire staff, faculty, and administrators in determining effective strategies to achieve these objectives. It acknowledges the potential for organizations to have mission drift and emphasizes the need for intentional awareness when this may be happening.	1. Department Shares: Provide opportunities to familiarize ourselves with the structure, purpose, and objectives of every Asbury department to foster greater levels of collaboration and understanding. 2. Reenvisioning Experience: Develop a reenvisioning experience that reminds and envisions us about Asbury's vision, values, and history. 3. Strategic Plan: Revisit the strategic plan to clarify understanding, make adjustments if necessary, and define implementation steps. 4. Workforce Analysis: Conduct a workforce analysis to understand the level of support and resources required to accomplish the strategic plan.
Decision Making This seeks to improve decision-making processes at the seminary. It examines power dynamics, communication channels, collaboration, and the establishment of safe forums for addressing concerns.	1. Cabinet Functioning: Examine current patterns of leadership and identify next step actions that will strengthen how they work together and how they provide leadership to Asbury. <i>Note: The Cabinet includes the President and Vice-Presidents.</i> 2. Cascading Communication: Establish a cascading communication process, enabling the Cabinet to promptly relay meeting outcomes and decisions to departments that fosters two-way interaction. 3. Definitions: Clarify the meanings of shared governance and accreditation and their relevance to decision-making in our daily work. 4. Decision-Making Guidelines: Specify decision-making guidelines for the various Asbury teams and committees. Included is an operational plan to ensure decisions made considering their impact on others.

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A Working Community This envisions a strong and interconnected community at Asbury Seminary, where people are prioritized and feel like they belong. Positive relationships are fostered between different departments and members of the administration, faculty, schools, and staff. It emphasizes preserving individual identities, empowering members, respecting differences, and valuing truth, gratitude, and promise-keeping, while seeking to resolve conflicts fairly and build trust.	1. Asbury Global: Integrate and involve Asbury Global in a way that results in a greater sense of connection to the overall mission. 2. Connection Opportunities: Create connection points for the purpose of building and developing relationships across schools, departments, and extension sites. 3. Teamwork: Define how we'll foster cross school, department, and extension site teamwork and communicate in a healthy way.
Truth Telling This highlights the importance of truthful and transparent communication. It aims to foster a culture where both positive and hard information is shared, and genuine truth-telling is practiced, promoting clarity, vulnerability, and openness.	1. Transparency: Increase the level of transparency including how information is presented, multiplicity of voices, understanding of department budgets, and the sharing of information with and from the Board. 2. Raising Concerns: Develop and implement protocols that clearly outline how concerns can be raised and how they'll be addressed.
Employee Retention This recognizes and appreciates the significance of every member in the Asbury Seminary working community, with a focus on employee retention. It aims to achieve this by offering fair compensation, including pay and benefits like insurance and leave policies, fostering a commitment to continuous professional development, and actively listening to and recognizing employee concerns, ideas, achievements, and growth opportunities.	1. Compensation and Benefits: Reassess, clarify, and communicate Asbury's compensation and benefits philosophy. 2. Leave Policies: Review and update the following leave policies: maternity, paternity, family, and mission. 3. Professional Development: Implement a developmental framework that encourages and equips each team member to take a next step in their professional growth.

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Spiritual Formation/Sanctification This is rooted in Asbury's commitment to sending out sanctified individuals. It focuses on engaging staff, faculty, and administration in an ongoing journey of spiritual formation seeking holiness and spiritual transformation.	1. Spiritual Journey: Design a spiritual healing and renewal experience for the Asbury community. Included is a rethinking of the chapel strategy. 2. Pastoral Care: Provide seminary-funded pastoral care sessions for faculty and staff. 3. Spiritual Leadership: Equip those in leadership positions in the <i>First Loved</i> content.